The Bureau of Meteorology

IDS11072
Australian Government Bureau of Meteorology
South Australia

Coastal Waters Forecast for South Australia

Issued at 3:30 pm CDT on Sunday 18 October 2026
for the period until midnight CDT Wednesday 21 October 2026.

Please be aware
Wind and wave forecasts are averages. Wind gusts can be 40 per cent stronger than the forecast, and stronger still in squalls and thunderstorms. Maximum waves can be twice the forecast height.

Warning Information

For latest warnings go to www.bom.gov.au, subscribe to RSS feeds, call 1300 659 210* or listen for warnings on relevant TV and radio broadcasts.

Weather Situation

A slow-moving high pressure system over the Tasman Sea extends a ridge over eastern SA. A trough of low pressure over WA will move eastwards into western SA late Sunday and reach southeastern parts later Monday, while a weakening cold front crosses the Bight. The trough lingers in the east through the middle of the week as a weak high pressure system forms in the Bight. This trough weakens on Thursday as a second trough moves into the west from WA.

Far West Coast: WA-SA Border to Fowlers Bay

Forecast for Sunday 18 October until midnight

Winds: Easterly 15 to 20 knots turning northeasterly in the late evening. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. A thunderstorm likely with possible squalls.

Forecast for Monday 19 October

Winds: South to southwesterly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 metres inshore, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres offshore. Weather: The chance of a thunderstorm in the early morning. Mostly sunny day.

Forecast for Tuesday 20 October

Winds: Southerly 10 to 15 knots turning east to southeasterly during the day. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres. Weather: Cloud clearing.

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October

Winds: East to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending east to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots during the morning. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres offshore. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Upper West Coast: Fowlers Bay to Elliston

Forecast for Sunday 18 October until midnight

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming east to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots in the late afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 metres. Weather: Mostly clear. The chance of a thunderstorm later tonight.

Forecast for Monday 19 October

Winds: North to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots shifting south to southwesterly in the middle of the day. Winds reaching up to 25 knots inshore in the late afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre during the morning, then increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the afternoon. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres,

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decreasing to 1.5 metres by early evening. Weather: Mostly sunny. 60% chance of showers in the early morning. A thunderstorm likely in the morning.

Forecast for Tuesday 20 October

Winds: Southerly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October

Winds: Southeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres during the afternoon. Weather: Sunny.

Lower West Coast: Elliston to Cape Carnot

Forecast for Sunday 18 October until midnight

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming south to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the late afternoon then tending northeast to southeasterly in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres by early evening. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Monday 19 October

Winds: North to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots shifting south to southwesterly in the early afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres. Weather: Mostly sunny. 60% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning.

Forecast for Tuesday 20 October

Winds: Southerly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. The chance of a thunderstorm inshore in the early morning.

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October

Winds: South to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending east to southeasterly below 10 knots during the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres during the morning. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Central Coast

Forecast for Sunday 18 October until midnight

Winds: East to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots, reaching up to 20 knots in the west in the late evening. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres by early evening. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Monday 19 October

Winds: North to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots shifting south to southwesterly in the late afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 50% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm.

Forecast for Tuesday 20 October

Winds: Southerly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning and early afternoon.

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October

Winds: Variable about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres during the morning. Weather: Cloud clearing.

South Central Coast

Forecast for Sunday 18 October until midnight

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots, reaching up to 20 knots west of Kangaroo Island in the late evening. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres by early evening. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Monday 19 October

Winds: Northeasterly 15 to 20 knots shifting west to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots in the late afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre by early evening. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. The chance of a thunderstorm.

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Forecast for Tuesday 20 October

Winds: Southwesterly 10 to 15 knots turning south to southeasterly below 10 knots during the day. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Cloudy. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning.

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October

Winds: South to southeasterly about 10 knots becoming easterly during the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Upper South East Coast: Murray Mouth to Cape Jaffa

Forecast for Sunday 18 October until midnight

Winds: East to northeasterly about 10 knots increasing to 10 to 15 knots in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Monday 19 October

Winds: Northeasterly 15 to 20 knots turning northerly during the morning. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre during the afternoon. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres during the morning. Weather: Partly cloudy. The chance of a thunderstorm offshore at night.

Forecast for Tuesday 20 October

Winds: Northwest to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending southeast to southwesterly before dawn. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 60% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning.

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October

Winds: South to southeasterly about 10 knots increasing to 10 to 15 knots during the afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres during the afternoon. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Lower South East Coast: Cape Jaffa to SA-VIC Border

Forecast for Sunday 18 October until midnight

Winds: Northeasterly about 10 knots increasing to 10 to 15 knots in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres north of Port MacDonnell. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Monday 19 October

Winds: North to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots, reaching up to 25 knots offshore during the morning. Winds tending north to northwesterly 10 to 15 knots during the day. Seas: 1 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1 metre by early evening. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Tuesday 20 October

Winds: Northwest to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots tending south to southwesterly before dawn then becoming variable about 10 knots in the morning. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 50% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning and early afternoon.

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October

Winds: South to southeasterly about 10 knots increasing to 10 to 15 knots during the afternoon then becoming east to southeasterly about 10 knots during the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Spencer Gulf

Forecast for Sunday 18 October until midnight

Winds: East to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Monday 19 October

Winds: North to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots shifting south to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots in the late evening. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: South to southwesterly around 1 metre south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy. The chance of a thunderstorm.

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Forecast for Tuesday 20 October

Winds: Southwesterly 10 to 15 knots turning southerly 15 to 20 knots during the morning and early afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres north of Cowell to Wallaroo by early evening. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to around 1 metre south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning and afternoon.

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October

Winds: South to southeasterly 15 to 20 knots tending south to southwesterly during the afternoon then tending south to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots during the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres north of Cowell to Wallaroo during the afternoon or evening. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo during the afternoon or evening. Weather: Cloud clearing.

Gulf St Vincent

Forecast for Sunday 18 October until midnight

Winds: Northeast to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending northeasterly in the late evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Monday 19 October

Winds: Northeasterly 15 to 20 knots tending northerly 10 to 15 knots in the morning then becoming variable about 10 knots in the late afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing below 1 metre around midday. Swell: South to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. The chance of a thunderstorm in the evening.

Forecast for Tuesday 20 October

Winds: Northwest to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending west to southwesterly before dawn then tending south to southwesterly in the early morning. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 60% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning and afternoon.

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October

Winds: Southerly 10 to 15 knots turning southeasterly below 10 knots during the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Cloud clearing.

Investigator Strait

Forecast for Sunday 18 October until midnight

Winds: Easterly about 10 knots increasing to 10 to 15 knots in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Monday 19 October

Winds: Northeasterly 15 to 20 knots tending northerly in the morning then becoming variable about 10 knots in the evening. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing below 1 metre during the afternoon. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning. Weather: Partly cloudy. The chance of a thunderstorm in the evening.

Forecast for Tuesday 20 October

Winds: South to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots tending south to southeasterly during the morning and early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning.

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October

Winds: Southerly 10 to 15 knots turning southeasterly during the morning. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

The next routine forecast will be issued at 9:30 pm CDT Sunday.

* Calls to 1300 numbers cost around 27.5c incl. GST, higher from mobiles or public phones. Marine forecasts are also available on VHF and HF radio. View the radio schedule on www.bom.gov.au/marine

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